CHAO FA

The Trail. *Laos, 1975 to 1980. Walk south from the burned village, recover the nine squ river in flood. Winter: the Toll, then the council.*

TIME · ONE TURN IS ONE SEASON

1975	1	2	3	4	1976	5	6	7	8	1977	9	10
cold +0	Spring · start	Summer · monsoon	Fall · nplooj zeeg	Winter · ntuj no · Toll, council	cold +1	Spring · nplooj hlav	Summer · monsoon	Fall · nplooj zeeg	Winter · ntuj no · Toll, council	cold +1	Spring · nplooj hlav	Summ monso

HOME



Village Ruins
Face up. The party starts here.

THE HILLS

Shuffle the 4, lay 3 face down, 1 back in the box: Swidden Fields · Pine Ridge · Long Tieng Airstrip · Plain of Jars



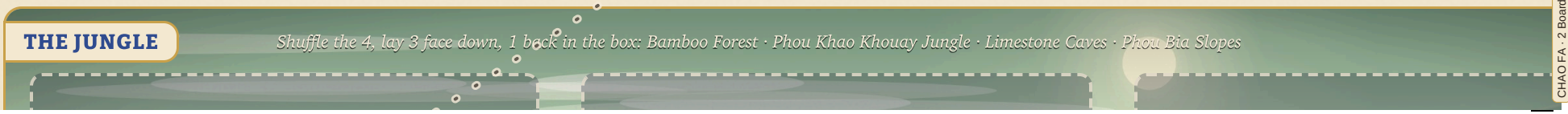
Hills place
Face down until scouted. Its search deck lies on the tile.

Hills place
Face down until scouted. Its search deck lies on the tile.

Hills place
Face down until scouted. Its search deck lies on tile.

THE JUNGLE

Shuffle the 4, lay 3 face down, 1 back in the box: Bamboo Forest · Phou Khao Khouay Jungle · Limestone Caves · Phou Bia Slopes



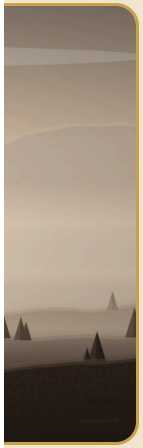
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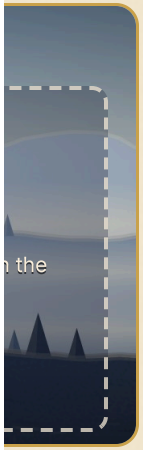
CHAO FA · 2 Board · sheet 1 of 4

glue sheet 3 over this margin

ares of the story cloth, and cross the Mekong before the camps close. One turn is one season; the time marker moves at the end of each. Blue edge: monsoon, the

er · on	11 Fall · nplooj zeeg	12 Winter · ntuj no · Toll, council	**1978** cold +2	13 Spring · nplooj hlav	14 Summer · monsoon	15 Fall · nplooj zeeg	16 Winter · ntuj no · Toll, council	**1979** cold +2	17 Spring · nplooj hlav	18 Summer · monsoon	19 Fall · nplooj zeeg	20 Winter · the last season







FOOD · START WITH 3 PER VILLAGER · MAX 20

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20

HOPE · 0 TO 6

0	1	2	3	4	5	6
Toll 2 worse, 1 action less	Toll 1 worse	Toll 1 worse	start		Toll 1 better	Toll 1 better

THE STORY CLOTH · ALL NINE SQUARES TO CROSS



SETUP

1. Village Ruins face up at the top; each row's tiles shuffled, three laid face down, the fourth back in the box (or a setup card decides).
2. Each place's search deck shuffled, face down on its tile.
3. Food 3 per villager, Hope 3, time on 1. Squares already sewn: 2 for a party of 6, 3 for 5, 4 for 4, 5 for 3 (see the cloth).
4. Each villager holds the first of their own items. Shuffle the Fortune deck, face down. Season deck: the From 1977 cards shuffled under the rest.

MOVING

1. **Scout** (1 action, 1 Food): turn one hidden place next to the party face up.

✂ trim this edge, lay it over sheet 1

CHAO FA · 2 Board · sheet 2 of 4

glue sheet 4 over this margin

Jungle place
Face down until scouted. Its search deck lies on the tile.

Jungle place
Face down until scouted. Its search deck lies on the tile.

Jungle place
Face down until scouted. Its search deck lies on the tile.

THE LOWLANDS

Shuffle the 4, lay 3 face down, 1 back in the box: Lao Farm Village · Hin Heup Bridge · Nam Xan Valley · Vientiane Plain

Lowlands place
Face down until scouted. Its search deck lies on the tile.

Lowlands place
Face down until scouted. Its search deck lies on the tile.

Lowlands place
Face down until scouted. Its search deck lies on the tile.

The tributary · crossing it in Summer or Fall: a Fortune card, on 1–2 the heaviest load loses an item

THE RIVER

Shuffle the 3, lay 3 face down, 1 back in the box: Mekong Reeds · Fishing Hamlet · Tha Deua Ferry

River place
Face down until scouted. Its search deck lies on the tile.

River place
Face down until scouted. Its search deck lies on the tile.

River place
Face down until scouted. Its search deck lies on the tile.

The Mekong

THAILAND BEYOND

Cross with all nine squares, from any river place. Children and the sick go first; each person or pair walks the lane in turn.

1 The bank
THE RIVER PATROL

Its own row of the Patrol table. No escape cards. Up to 3 clashes: beaten, you reach the water unseen; still standing, you break for the water **under fire.** A hired boat takes 4 a trip; a second trip meets the

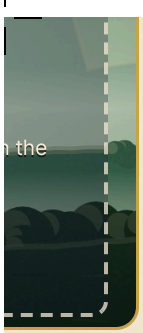
2 Down to the water
ONE FORTUNE CARD EACH

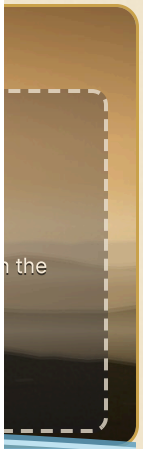
Hit on **3 or less** (7 under fire): killed on 1 (1–2 under fire), otherwise wounded. A Safe Crossing Place, Travel by Night and Gao B each make it 1–2 better.

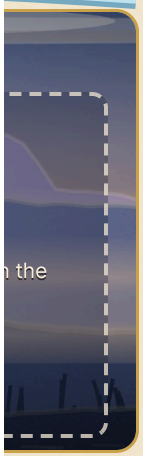
3

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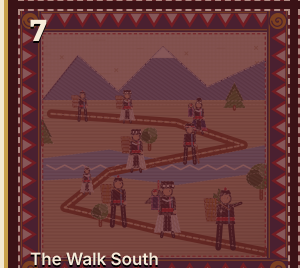
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Into the Forest · party of 4 | Hiding · party of 3 | Fire from the Sky







up.

2. **Travel** (before anyone acts, 1 Food): the whole party moves to a face-up place ahead, diagonally ahead or beside it; draw a Fortune card against the place's Danger; the season ends.
3. A finished camp stays on its tile. Everything else is on the player aids.

THE OMEN ROW · EACH OMEN CARD LIES IN THE NEXT SLOT; DRAW A FORTUNE CARD WHEN IT ARRIVES

1	2	3	4	5
Turning Point on 5 or less	Turning Point on 10 or less	Turning Point on 15 or less	the Turning Point is certain	the Turning Point is certain

A SEASON · THE PHASE MARKER

1. **Season card**
   Draw the top card and do what it says. Monsoon (blue edge): the river is in flood.
2. **Travel?**
   Before anyone acts the party may Travel (1 Food): draw a Fortune card against the new place, forage there, and the season ends.
3. **Actions**
   Each villager, in any order, 2 actions (1 in a Sweep). Search, Scout, Forage, Rest, Camp, powers, Cross.
4. **Winter only**
   Eat 1 Food each (none: Hungry). The Toll: one Fortune card each, Sick on 5 or less. Then the council adopts a law.
5. **Time marker**
   Move it one season. 1980 arrives: the game ends.

Season deck

Face down. One card at the start of every season.

Season discard

Face up. Shuffle it back in when the deck runs out.

THE LAWS, THE FORTUNE DECK (FACE DOWN, RESHUFFLE WHEN IT RUNS OUT), STRANGERS, RIVER CARDS AND TURNING POINTS WAIT BESIDE THE BOARD; ADOPTED LAWS LIE FACE UP.

In the current

A RIVER CARD, THEN A FORTUNE CARD

Swept away on **13 or less**: monsoon +4, child, elder, sick or wounded +2, boat −6, raft −3, Safe Crossing Place −3, floats up to −4, Spring low water −2. A pair walks on one set of draws; a child is

4 Swept away

ONE FORTUNE CARD

Drowned on **12 or less**: monsoon +3, vulnerable +2, cannot swim without a float +2; 2 better with a line from the Thai bank, 2 better off a raft or boat. 18 or more: washed up alone on the Thai bank with

5 The Thai bank

NONG KHAI · BAN VINAI

Out of the water. When no one is left in the river the game ends: read **Ending A** and say the names of those who did not reach it.